Seth Strickland

strickland@cmu.edu · +1 607 288 2604 · Pittsburgh, PA
linkedin.com/in/sethjstrickland · buzzcauldron.github.io · github.com/buzzcauldron

Profile

Writer, editor, and communication consultant with a PhD and over a decade of experience teaching writing and guiding long-form projects to publication. Skilled at translating complex, specialist material into clear prose for general, professional, and executive audiences, and at coaching authors through developmental editing from first draft to finished, market-ready work.

Core Competencies

Developmental & Line Editing • Copyediting & Proofreading • Curriculum & Instructional Design • Rhetoric & Argumentation • Plain-Language & Technical Writing • Public Communication & Talks • Editorial Standards & Style Guides • Grant & Proposal Writing • LaTeX, Markdown, Word

Experience

Writing Consultant & Faculty **2022 – Present**
Gilliam Writers Group, New York, NY

- Advise creative and academic authors on structure, revision, and developmental editing, bringing several book- and article-length projects from draft to completion and to market.
- Place clients in MFA and equivalent programs regularly.
- Deliver line-level editing and manuscript feedback across fiction, nonfiction, and scholarly genres.

Lecturer, Writing & Communication **2023 – Present**
Carnegie Mellon University, Pittsburgh, PA

- Design and teach professional, argumentative, and interdisciplinary writing courses, including *Writing for the Professions* and a course uniting computing and rhetoric.
- Build reusable curricula and guides — including materials on the critical, effective use of AI writing tools — and provide individualized editorial feedback to 50+ students each term.
- Authored the successful proposal for a competitive NSF ACCESS research allocation supporting a departmental digital-humanities project.
- Recognized as a Provost's Inclusive Teaching Fellow.

Academic and Administrative Operations Advisor (Special Faculty) **Sep – Dec 2026**
Carnegie Mellon University, Department of English, Pittsburgh, PA

- Part-time special faculty appointment (∼10–15 hrs/week), extended through Dec 2026: graduate recruitment, Dietrich application review, public-facing grad FAQs, PhD certificate launch coordination, handbook and RPT support, and graduate data review.
- Planned academic activities for visiting researcher Erik Ketzan; assessed academic-affairs administration and adjunct staffing structure for the Department Head.

Contributing Editor & Reviewer **2022 – 2025**
Year's Work in English Studies (Oxford UP) and others, Remote

- Authored the commissioned annual survey chapter on Middle English (Langland) for four consecutive volumes, synthesizing a year of scholarship into a concise, authoritative review.
- Served as peer reviewer and book reviewer for scholarly journals and a publication on online course and curriculum design.

Co-Founder & Organizer **2022 – Present**
Public Works & Issuing Citations, Ithaca, NY / Pittsburgh, PA

- Co-founded and ran interdisciplinary public talk series connecting academic speakers with general audiences (publicworks.info), editing and shaping talks for accessibility.
- Established a cross-disciplinary forum for presenting work-in-progress to non-specialist peers.

Program Collaborator **AY 2026–27**

Beatrice Institute, Pittsburgh, PA

- Co-proposed (with James DeMasi, Meredith McDonough Thornburgh, and Grant Martsolf) an eight-event undergraduate series on marriage, dating, mate selection, and sexual integrity; $20,000 Collegiate Cultural Foundation grant awarded without revision.
- Seminar leader: "Call Him Hither: Have We Ever Known How to Date?" (readings from *Wing to Wing, Oar to Oar* and related courtship texts).

Instructor & Lecturer (earlier) **2014 – 2023**

Cornell University & Saint Louis University, Ithaca, NY / St. Louis, MO

- Taught writing, rhetoric, and research composition as Instructor of Record and Lecturer across a range of undergraduate courses.
- Recognized as a University Writing Services Mentor of the Month.

Selected Publications

- Essays in the *Pittsburgh Review of Books*: " 'Magnifica Humanitas' and Bullshit Jobs" (2026); "Medieval Timekeeping as a Counterpoint for AI-Enabled Time-Sensitive Systems" (forthcoming).
- Co-author, "Democratizing the Medieval English Legal Tradition," *arXiv* (2026).
- Poetry in *Goodbye, Mexico: Poems of Remembrance* (Texas A&M University Press), *Stink Eye Magazine*, and *The Pierian*.
- Scholarly reviews in *Law and History Review* and *Literary Research*.

Selected Projects

Research Party — a digital-humanities platform I designed, built, and launched for mapping bias and social networks across bibliographies. See it live at research-party.com; further tools and code at github.com/buzzcauldron.

Education

PhD, Medieval Literature — Cornell University 2022

MA, English — Saint Louis University 2016

BA, Classics & English Literature — Hillsdale College 2012